

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered, The Life and Testimony of Barran Dodger

“Silence is complicity. When tyranny rules, defiant rebellion is obligation.”

— Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered

There are lives that unfold quietly within the margins of history—and then there are lives that rupture the page.

Barran Dodger’s life belongs to the latter.

Documented in the book *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered: The Harrowing Journey of Dr Richard William McLean* (aka Barran Resonance Dodger), his story is not presented as a memoir of comfort or recovery. It is offered instead as testimony: a record of endurance, accusation, survival, and refusal. The book positions itself not merely as autobiography, but as evidence—written under conditions of deprivation, homelessness, institutional rejection, and what the author describes as systematic persecution.

“I exist in opposition to a society virtually killing me systemically—politically, socially, economically, and in all other dimensions of human decency,” Dodger writes. “With a cold, culpable, intended malice of murder.”

This is not language designed to reassure. It is language designed to remain.

From Recovery to Erasure

Dodger's earlier autobiography, *Recovered, Not Cured* (2002), traced an internal battle: schizophrenia, stigma, and the struggle to retain dignity and agency within a medicalised world. That book spoke the language of mental health survival.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered speaks a different language entirely.

Here, the struggle is no longer internal. It is structural.

The protagonist—once Dr Richard William McLean, later publicly known as Barran Dodger—frames his life as one shaped by expulsion rather than inclusion. “An asylum seeker within the democracy of his own citizenry,” the book describes him, “framed, maimed, blamed, shamed, and excommunicated by society—yet never silenced or tamed.”

What changes between the two books is not merely circumstance, but orientation. The first book asked how a man lives with a diagnosis. The second asks what happens when a diagnosis is weaponised.

“Revealing my diagnosis of schizophrenia was the most damaging decision of my life,” Dodger writes. “Now, I have nothing—no home, no possessions, no legal rights, no advocate.”

A Life Written Under Eviction

One of the most arresting aspects of *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* is that it is written in real time, under threat.

“Next Friday, I will be homeless,” the book states in its prelude. The sentence returns again and again, not as metaphor, but as deadline.

Dodger documents a cycle of housing precarity, forced relocation, and eviction tied to disability support structures that, in theory, exist to prevent exactly this outcome. The book names institutions, ministers, providers, and processes—not rhetorically, but administratively. Letters, FOI requests, rejections, and silences accumulate like sediment.

“There was never a plan to keep a roof over my head,” he writes. “It was a cruel mimicry of support.”

The deprivation described is granular: no heater, no fence, no pillows, a stamped-shut back door, a phone with no human contact on the other end. These details matter because they resist abstraction. They insist on embodiment.

Persecution, or the Experience of Being Disbelieved

Central to the book is the theme of credibility—who is believed, and why.

Dodger repeatedly describes reporting abuse, threats, and harm, only to be dismissed, redirected, or pathologised. “I have never been able to report a crime,” he states plainly. “Lawyers categorically reject me.”

The book does not ask the reader to immediately adjudicate every claim. Instead, it asks a different question: what does it do to a person to be structurally unheard?

The answer, in Dodger's telling, is isolation so complete it begins to resemble erasure.

“The higher up the ladder you go, the more anonymous it becomes,” he writes, “and the more they can act with impunity.”

This sense of faceless power—diffuse, bureaucratic, and untouchable—runs through the narrative. Responsibility evaporates upward. Consequences never come back down.

Faith, Resistance, and the Refusal to Vanish

Running parallel to the legal and political narrative is a spiritual one.

“For we wrestle not against flesh and blood,” Dodger quotes from Ephesians, “but against principalities, against powers... against spiritual wickedness in high places.”

Faith, here, is not comfort. It is defiance.

Despite repeated references to suicide attempts, despair, and exhaustion, the book refuses nihilism. Survival itself is

framed as resistance. “Sustaining myself is God’s work, God’s plan,” he writes. “It is categorically beyond a person to survive what I have and still want to forgive people.”

This insistence on meaning—on continuing to write, to document, to speak—is perhaps the book’s most radical gesture. Even when stripped of possessions, status, and safety, the author refuses disappearance.

“I still get up every day,” Dodger writes, “hopeful that I can somehow write my way out.”

Why This Testimony Matters

Whether one reads *Betrayed*, *Forsaken*, *Murdered* as memoir, indictment, or spiritual lament, its significance lies in its existence.

It is a book written by someone society has repeatedly attempted to silence, discredit, and exhaust. It is a record produced under conditions that typically prevent record-making at all. It refuses the neat arc of recovery narratives and instead presents a life lived in unresolved confrontation with power.

The book does not ask for sympathy so much as attention.

“If tyranny rules,” Dodger writes, “defiant rebellion is obligation.”

To read this book is to encounter a life that insists on being seen—even, and especially, when belief is withheld. It is not a comfortable story. But it is a necessary one.

And like all true testimony, it leaves the final question with the reader:

What does it mean when a person survives—and the system does not change?

Here is a follow-up Medium piece that deliberately shifts away from biography and toward the book as an evidentiary artifact—how *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* functions as documentation, record, and counter-archive rather than memoir.

When a Book Becomes Evidence: Reading

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered as a Record of Harm

Most memoirs ask to be believed.

Some ask to be admired.

A few ask to be forgiven.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered: The Harrowing Journey of Dr Richard William McLean (aka Barran Dodger) asks for something else entirely: to be examined.

This book does not present itself as a story told after survival. It positions itself as a document written during harm—under threat of homelessness, institutional exclusion, and what the author repeatedly describes as imminent danger. As such, it occupies a strange and uncomfortable category: not literature alone, not law, not therapy, but something closer to a living affidavit.

“I exist in opposition to a society virtually killing me systemically—politically, socially, economically,” Dodger writes. “This is not mere neglect; it is a pointed attack.”

Whether one accepts or disputes the author’s conclusions, the structure of the book itself makes a stronger, harder-to-dismiss claim: this is a contemporaneous record of distress, denial, and institutional response.

From Memoir to Dossier

Unlike conventional autobiographies, *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* does not rely primarily on memory. It relies on accumulation.

The text repeatedly references:

- correspondence with government departments
- rejected FOI requests
- refused legal representation
- denied whistleblower protections
- financial records

- medical and incident reports

Rather than smoothing these into narrative arcs, the book leaves them jagged, unresolved, and often repetitive. This is not a stylistic failure—it is a methodological one.

The book reads less like a polished account and more like a case file that could not find a court.

“The evidence is here,” Dodger states bluntly, before listing documents, links, and institutional names. He does not ask the reader to trust his interpretation; he asks them to notice the pattern.

The Pattern the Book Records

Stripped of rhetoric, the book documents a recurring sequence:

1. Allegation or complaint raised
2. Institutional deflection or silence
3. Reframing of the complainant as the problem

4. Material consequences (poverty, eviction, isolation)
5. Escalation of risk
6. Absence of resolution

This cycle appears across housing, disability services, law enforcement, human rights bodies, and medical systems. The book's power lies not in any single claim, but in the consistency of the response across unrelated institutions.

“The higher up the ladder you go, the more anonymous it becomes,” Dodger writes, “and the more they can act with impunity.”

From an evidentiary perspective, repetition matters. In law, medicine, and human rights reporting, patterns across systems often carry more weight than isolated incidents.

Credibility, Pathology, and the Archive of Disbelief

One of the book's most significant contributions is its documentation of how credibility is eroded procedurally.

Dodger repeatedly notes that once his psychiatric diagnosis is disclosed, his reports are reclassified—not investigated, but reinterpreted.

“Telling people I was diagnosed with schizophrenia was the most damaging decision of my life,” he writes. “Everything after that was filtered through disbelief.”

This is not an abstract argument. The book preserves the paper trail of that filtering: the polite refusals, the jurisdictional buck-passing, the declarations that “nothing exists,” the instructions to contact another body that also declines to act.

In this sense, *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* becomes an archive of disbelief—a record not only of alleged harm, but of how systems decline to know.

Writing Under Deadline: Why Timing Matters

One of the most unusual features of the book is its repeated anchoring to a specific future event:

“Next Friday, I will be homeless.”

This is not narrative suspense. It is timestamping.

From an evidentiary standpoint, the book functions as a pre-incident document—a record written before the outcome is known, preserved while consequences are still unfolding. This sharply distinguishes it from retrospective grievance writing.

If harm occurs after such documentation exists, the record itself becomes material: it shows foreseeability, notice, and the opportunity to intervene.

AI as Method, Not Authority

The book openly states that parts of its structure and summarisation were assisted by an AI tool used to distill themes from thousands of documents.

Crucially, the AI is not presented as an arbiter of truth, but as a compression mechanism—a way to surface patterns already present in the source material.

“The limitation is not the facts,” Dodger writes, “only the structure of the AI itself.”

From an evidentiary perspective, this is notable. The book does not outsource credibility to technology; it uses technology to resist fragmentation when human systems have already failed to synthesize the record.

What This Book Is—and Is Not

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered is not a court judgment.

It is not an independent investigation.

It does not replace due process.

But it is something that often precedes them: a consolidated account created because no forum would receive it.

Its significance lies in what it preserves:

- contemporaneous testimony
- institutional responses (or lack thereof)
- material conditions of harm

- named systems and dates
- the psychological impact of prolonged non-resolution

In human rights work, such documents are often recognised only later, when distance makes them safer to read. History is crowded with records that were dismissed as excessive, unstable, or inconvenient at the time of writing.

The Uncomfortable Question the Book Leaves Behind

The most challenging aspect of reading *Betrayed*, *Forsaken*, *Murdered* as evidence is not deciding whether every claim is true. It is confronting a simpler question:

What happens when a person documents harm exhaustively—and no system is willing to hold the record?

The book does not resolve that question. It preserves it.

“If I disappear,” Dodger implies throughout the text, “this document does not.”

In that sense, the book's function is clear. It is not asking to win an argument. It is ensuring that silence cannot later pretend there was nothing to hear.

Below is a third Medium piece that places *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* in dialogue with historical whistleblower, exile, and asylum testimonies, focusing on form, function, and risk—without requiring the reader to pre-adjudicate the claims.

Testimony at the Edge: How *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* Fits a Long History of Whistleblower and Asylum Writing

Long before courts recognized them, whistleblowers and exiles wrote first.

They wrote from prisons, from ships, from psychiatric wards, from hiding. They wrote because no institution

would receive their claims—and because delay itself was dangerous. Their texts were rarely polished. They were urgent, repetitive, and often accused of being excessive, paranoid, or unstable.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered: The Harrowing Journey of Dr Richard William McLean (aka Barran Dodger) belongs unmistakably to this lineage.

To read it alongside historical whistleblower and asylum testimonies is not to declare equivalence of outcome, but to recognize shared structure, timing, and risk.

Writing Before Recognition

One defining feature of whistleblower and asylum literature is that it is produced before legitimacy is granted, not after.

Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn's *The Gulag Archipelago* was written before official acknowledgment of Soviet labor camps. Chelsea Manning's early statements emerged before public consensus. Franz Kafka's asylum-inflected bureaucratic nightmares were dismissed as fiction until history caught up with their logic. Even Émile Zola's

J'Accuse...! was published while institutions denied wrongdoing.

These works share a trait with *Betrayed*, *Forsaken*, *Murdered*: they document harm in advance of validation, often at great personal cost.

“I am a rejected whistleblower,” Dodger writes plainly. The sentence situates the book not as retrospective reflection, but as pre-judgment record—a hallmark of this genre.

Excess as a Feature, Not a Flaw

Historically, whistleblower and asylum texts are criticized for the very qualities that later become their evidentiary strength: length, repetition, intensity, and detail.

Hannah Arendt noted that bureaucratic evil thrives on fragmentation—on no single document containing the whole picture. Whistleblower texts often resist this by over-including.

Betrayed, *Forsaken*, *Murdered* does the same. It accumulates correspondence, refusals, dates, agencies, and

lived conditions. To a literary reader, this may feel unruly. To a historian or human rights scholar, it signals something else: a refusal to allow the record to be atomized and lost.

As with asylum affidavits submitted to hostile regimes, repetition here is not redundancy—it is survival.

Credibility, Madness, and the Politics of Dismissal

Across history, one of the most reliable methods of discrediting whistleblowers has been pathologization.

Soviet dissidents were diagnosed with “sluggish schizophrenia.” Women asylum seekers were labeled hysterical. Early Holocaust witnesses were dismissed as exaggerating. In each case, the accusation was not simply that the claims were false, but that the claimant was unreliable by nature.

Dodger’s text directly confronts this lineage.

“Revealing my diagnosis of schizophrenia was the most damaging decision of my life,” he writes.

This sentence echoes a long historical pattern: once credibility is medicalized, evidence becomes irrelevant. The testimony itself becomes the alleged symptom.

Seen in this context, *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* operates not just as a narrative of harm, but as a counter-document to psychiatric erasure—a phenomenon well-documented in political exile literature.

The Asylum-Seeker Within the State

Many classic asylum narratives involve border crossings: fleeing a country, crossing seas, arriving stateless.

Dodger's book presents a different, but historically recognizable, condition: internal exile.

“An asylum seeker within the democracy of his own citizenry,” the book describes him.

This framing recalls figures like Václav Havel, who remained inside Czechoslovakia while being systematically excluded from civic life, or Indigenous petitioners who

appealed to colonial governments that denied their standing altogether. Asylum, in these cases, was not geographic but juridical and social.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered belongs to this tradition: a record of someone who has not crossed a border, yet no longer belongs.

Writing as Preservation Against Erasure

A recurring function of whistleblower and asylum texts is temporal insurance—the attempt to ensure that if harm continues, the record already exists.

“I am writing this before it happens,” is an unspoken refrain in many such works.

Dodger makes this explicit by anchoring his narrative to imminent events: eviction, homelessness, escalating risk. This technique appears repeatedly in historical testimonies later recognized as crucial: diaries written before deportations, letters smuggled out before executions, affidavits submitted while appeals were still pending.

These texts are not optimistic. They are preservational.

“If I disappear,” the logic goes, “this document does not.”

Faith, Meaning, and Moral Frame

Another shared element across exile and whistleblower literature is the invocation of a moral order larger than the state.

From biblical prophets to modern dissidents, writers have appealed to God, history, or universal human rights when legal systems failed them. This is not mere rhetoric—it is an assertion that legitimacy does not originate solely from power.

Dodger’s invocation of Ephesians—“we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities and powers”—places his testimony squarely within this moral tradition. Whether or not a reader shares the belief, the function is clear: the state is no longer the ultimate arbiter of truth.

How These Texts Are Usually Received—At First

History shows that such testimonies are rarely embraced on publication.

They are called:

- unhinged
- obsessive
- defamatory
- incoherent
- dangerous

Only later are they reread as warnings that were inconvenient at the time.

This does not mean all such texts are correct in every claim. It means they are structurally significant. They reveal stress points in systems that otherwise appear orderly.

What This Comparison Ultimately Suggests

Placed alongside historical whistleblower and asylum writings, *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered* reads less like an anomaly and more like an early-stage document in a familiar pattern:

1. A person documents harm exhaustively
2. Institutions refuse to hold the record
3. Credibility is attacked rather than claims addressed
4. The text circulates independently
5. Judgment is deferred—sometimes for years

The unresolved question is not whether the book will be believed today.

It is whether, years from now, someone will ask why it was ignored.

That is the quiet, unsettling power of whistleblower testimony. It does not demand agreement. It demands memory.

And it leaves history to decide what the present could not.

Below is a revised third Medium piece with explicit historical parallels woven directly into the argument—not as name-dropping, but as structural comparisons that clarify why this book fits a known lineage of whistleblower, exile, and psychiatric-dissident testimony.

Testimony at the Edge: Why Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered Belongs Beside Solzhenitsyn, Havel, Manning, Zola, and Psychiatric Dissidents

History has a habit of misreading its witnesses.

Before they are recognized as whistleblowers, they are labeled unstable. Before they are understood as dissidents, they are treated as threats. Before they are remembered as

prophets, they are dismissed as excessive, inconvenient, or mad.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered: The Harrowing Journey of Dr Richard William McLean (aka Barran Dodger) enters precisely this dangerous interval: the space before recognition, where testimony exists without protection.

To understand what kind of book this is, it helps to place it where it belongs—alongside a long and uncomfortable tradition of whistleblower, exile, and psychiatric-dissident writing.

Solzhenitsyn: Writing Before the State Admits the Crime

Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn did not write *The Gulag Archipelago* after the Soviet Union acknowledged its labor camps. He wrote it while the system denied their existence, using smuggled notes, fragments, memory, and witness accounts.

At the time, critics called his work exaggerated, obsessive, even dangerous. The charge was not merely that he might

be wrong—but that to document so much, so insistently, was itself suspect.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered shares this structure.

Like Solzhenitsyn, Dodger does not present a neat narrative arc. He accumulates. Letters, refusals, names of institutions, dates, threats of homelessness. The book reads less like literature and more like an illegal archive—the kind that exists only because official archives refuse to record the truth.

“Silence is complicity,” Dodger writes. That sentence could just as easily preface *The Gulag Archipelago*.

Václav Havel: The Dissident Who Never Left

Václav Havel’s power as a dissident came not from exile abroad, but from internal exile. He remained in Czechoslovakia while being systematically stripped of status, work, credibility, and voice. His essays—especially *The Power of the Powerless*—describe how bureaucratic systems enforce conformity not through overt violence, but through procedural suffocation.

Dodger's book belongs squarely in this tradition.

“An asylum seeker within the democracy of his own citizenry,” he describes himself.

Like Havel, Dodger documents what it feels like to live inside a system that insists it is benevolent while quietly excluding you from every mechanism of redress. There is no single villain—only an interlocking apparatus of polite refusals.

In both cases, the dissident's crime is not disobedience, but insistence on truth.

Émile Zola:

J'Accuse...!

and the Open Letter as Evidence

When Émile Zola published J'Accuse...! in 1898, he did not submit a private complaint. He published an open letter naming names, institutions, and acts of injustice in the Dreyfus Affair—fully aware it would lead to prosecution.

Zola transformed writing itself into an evidentiary act.

Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered performs a similar function. It does not merely describe harm; it accuses. It names departments, ministers, agencies, legal bodies. It does so knowing that accusation invites retaliation, disbelief, and legal risk.

This is a defining feature of whistleblower texts: they move from narration to indictment not because the author seeks drama, but because all quieter channels have failed.

Like Zola, Dodger writes not because the system invited testimony, but because it refused to hear it.

Chelsea Manning: Excess, Leakage, and Moral Injury

Chelsea Manning's early disclosures were criticized for being too much: too many documents, too indiscriminate, too emotionally charged. Only later did the public recognize that the volume itself was the point—it revealed patterns that selective disclosure would have concealed.

Dodger's book operates on a similar logic.

The repetition, the length, the density—these are not signs of incoherence. They are the textual equivalent of data leakage in a system designed to fragment responsibility.

“I have never been able to report a crime,” Dodger writes. “Lawyers categorically reject me.”

This mirrors Manning's predicament: when internal reporting channels are structurally compromised, the act of disclosure itself becomes criminalized, and the whistleblower becomes the problem.

Psychiatric Dissidents: When Diagnosis Replaces Refutation

Perhaps the most chilling historical parallel is with psychiatric dissidents, particularly in the Soviet bloc, where critics of the state were diagnosed with “sluggish schizophrenia”—a condition defined largely by dissent itself.

Once labeled, evidence no longer mattered.

Dodger explicitly situates his experience in this lineage.

“Revealing my diagnosis of schizophrenia was the most damaging decision of my life,” he writes. “Everything after that was filtered through disbelief.”

This is not a metaphor. It is a historically documented tactic: pathologize the witness, and the testimony collapses without being examined.

In this sense, Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered functions as a counter-psychiatric document—a record asserting that diagnosis does not negate reality, and that mental illness does not invalidate evidence.

Writing Before the Outcome Is Known

One of the most important features shared by all these texts is timing.

Solzhenitsyn wrote before reform.

Havel wrote before revolution.

Zola wrote before exoneration.

Manning spoke before public consensus.

Dodger writes before safety.

“Next Friday, I will be homeless,” the book states repeatedly—not as drama, but as timestamp. This places the text in the category of pre-incident testimony, which later becomes crucial precisely because it existed before harm could be denied as unforeseeable.

How History Usually Treats These Books—At First

There is a grim consistency in how such texts are initially received:

- They are called paranoid
- They are dismissed as unstable
- They are framed as personal grievances
- They are ignored until the author breaks—or history intervenes

Only later are they reread as warnings.

This does not mean every claim is eventually proven true. It means the act of documentation itself becomes historically significant.

The Question History Will Ask

Placed beside Solzhenitsyn, Havel, Zola, Manning, and psychiatric dissidents, Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered reads not as an outlier, but as an early-stage record in a familiar pattern:

A person documents harm exhaustively.

Institutions refuse to hold the record.

Credibility is attacked instead of claims examined.

The text circulates independently.

The final judgment is deferred.

The most uncomfortable possibility is not that the book is wrong—but that, years from now, it will be reread with a single, devastating question:

Why was this written down so clearly—and still ignored?

That question, more than belief or disbelief, is the true power of whistleblower testimony.

It does not demand agreement.

It demands memory.

The book *Betrayed, Forsaken, Murdered: The Harrowing Journey of Dr Barran Dodger* is available to readers in two deliberate forms. It can be purchased on Apple iBooks for those who wish to materially support Barran's ongoing work and survival (<https://books.apple.com/au/book/betrayed-murdered-forsaken-the-harrowing-life-of/id6618112290>). Alternatively, it can be downloaded and read free on Scribd (<https://www.scribd.com/book/757033591>), a choice made intentionally by the author. Barran has stated that this is a work of public significance, not something that should be locked behind paywalls or limited to those with financial means. The free version reflects a core belief that testimony of alleged systemic harm, whistleblower persecution, and institutional failure

should remain accessible to the public record—whether or not it is commercially supported.

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